3.3.5 Concurrent Forces and Lami's Theorem

A collection of forces is said to be concurrent, if the lines of forces act at a common point. Figure 3.19 illustrates concurrent forces.

Concurrent forces need not be in the same plane. If they are in the same plane, they are concurrent as well as coplanar forces.

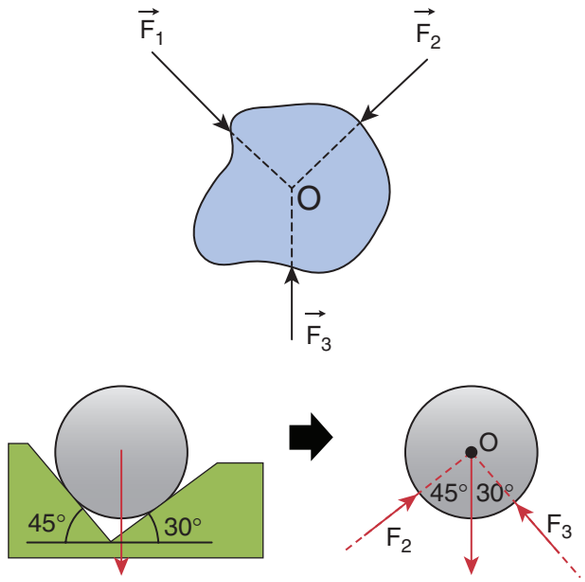


Figure 3.19 Concurrent forces

3.4 LAMI'S THEOREM

If a system of three concurrent and coplanar forces is in equilibrium, then Lami's theorem states that the magnitude of each force of the system is proportional to sine of the angle between the other two forces. The constant of proportionality is same for all three forces.

Let us consider three coplanar and concurrent forces $\vec{F}_1, \vec{F}_2$ and $\vec{F}_3$ which act at a common point O as shown in Figure 3.20. If the point is at equilibrium, then according to Lami's theorem

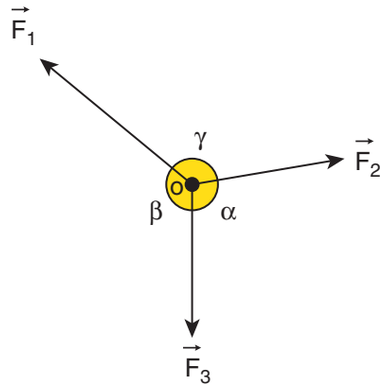


Figure 3.20 Three coplanar and concurrent forces $\vec{F}_1, \vec{F}_2$ and $\vec{F}_3$ acting at O

$$|\vec{F}_1| \propto \sin\alpha$$

$$|\vec{F}_2| \propto \sin\beta$$

$$|\vec{F}_3| \propto \sin\gamma$$

Therefore,
$$\frac{|\vec{F}_1|}{\sin\alpha} = \frac{|\vec{F}_2|}{\sin\beta} = \frac{|\vec{F}_3|}{\sin\gamma} \qquad (3.19)$$

Lami's theorem is useful to analyse the forces acting on objects which are in static equilibrium.

Application of Lami's Theorem

EXAMPLE 3.14

A baby is playing in a swing which is hanging with the help of two identical chains is at rest. Identify the forces acting on the baby. Apply Lami's theorem and find out the tension acting on the chain.

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